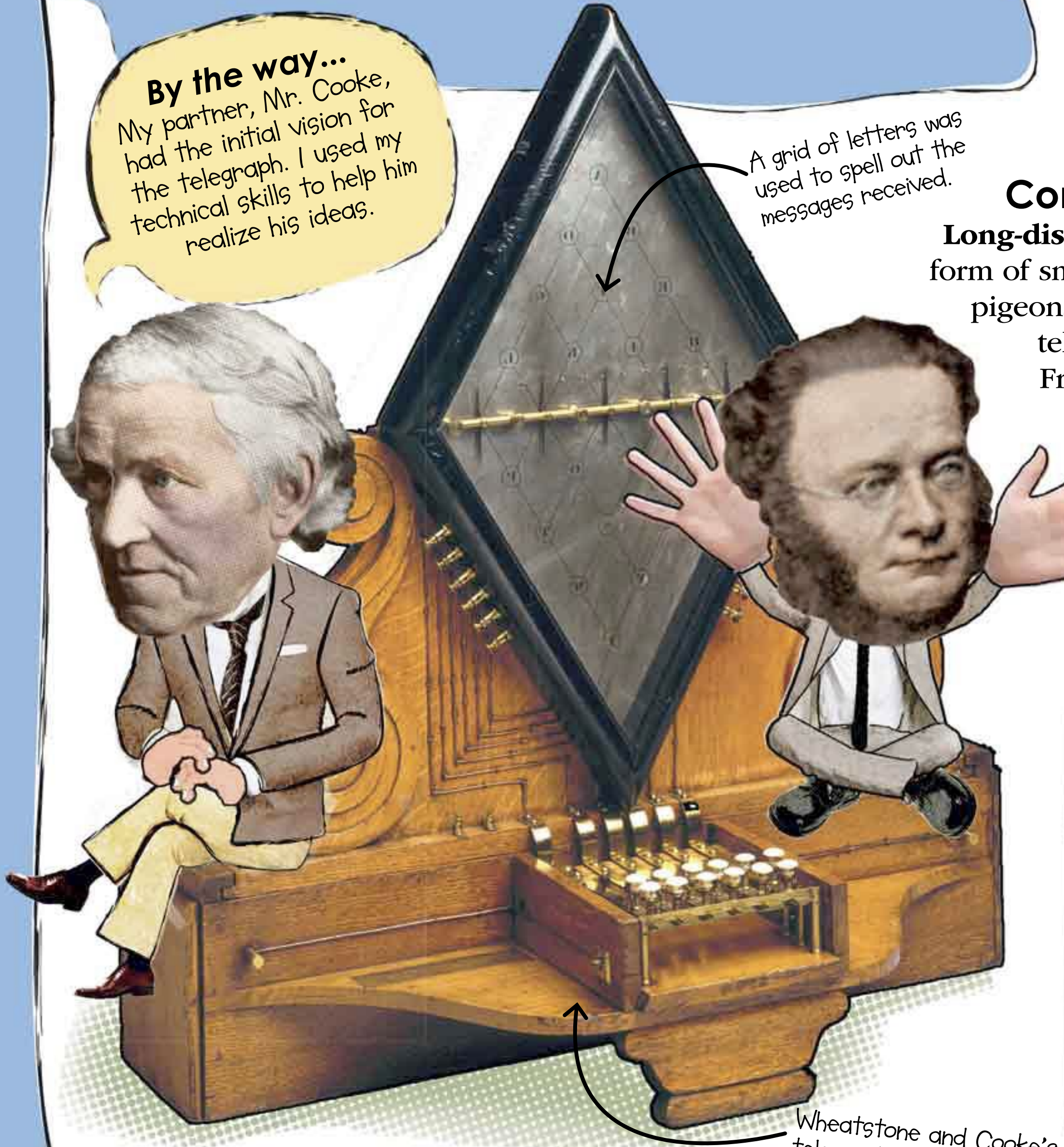
Telegraph

Tapping out the world's first LONG-DISTANCE electrical messages

Communication problems

Long-distance communication took the form of smoke signals, beacons, or carrier pigeons until 1792, when a semaphore telegraph system was invented by Frenchman **CLAUDE CHAPPE**. It used pairs of movable arms on station buildings (above) to represent letters and numbers to signal to the next station in the chain, but it was slow and **expensive to build**.

By the way...
My partner, Mr. Cooke, had the initial vision for the telegraph. I used my technical skills to help him realize his ideas.



Electric telegraphs

English inventors William Fothergill Cooke and Charles Wheatstone came up with the first electrical long-distance communication in 1837. Their **TELEGRAPH** could send messages through an electric wire without having to be within sight of the person receiving it. Americans Samuel Morse and Alfred Vail later developed ***a code of dots and dashes*** that became the standard telegraph code.

How it changed the world
The telegraph made it possible to send almost-instant messages across oceans and continents, starting a revolution in communication.

Telegraph takeover

In 1866, Europe and North America were linked when the first **transatlantic cables** were laid. Telegraph wires reached Australia six years later, and telegraphs could be sent all around the world when cable was laid under the **PACIFIC OCEAN** in 1902.